Digital Products & UX / Service & Transformation

LOOK — Beauty Marketplace

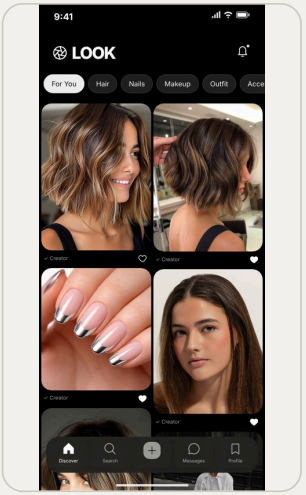
See the work first. Book the person who made it.

A Pinterest-like, image-led platform where every picture is real work by a real, local Creator. For users, it is a way to find a look and the person who can actually do it. For Creators, it is a living portfolio that turns their work into new customers.

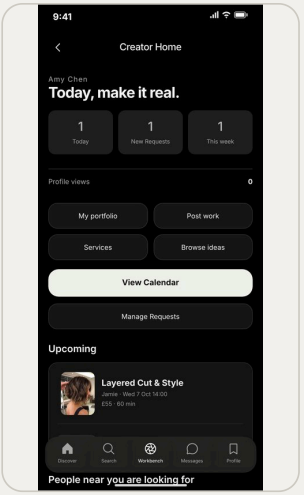
Interactive prototype · field research planned

Try the interactive prototype: yifan-zhu-portfolio-2026.vercel.app/demos/look/index.html

MY CONTRIBUTION	Product strategy, service and system design, information architecture, UI and AI-assisted prototyping of both the user and Creator sides
SCOPE	User + Creator mobile journeys
TYPE	Two-sided marketplace · mobile
STAGE	Working prototype, pre-pilot
BUILT WITH	Spec-first, AI-assisted web prototype



01 / Visual discovery



05 / The other side of the service

Every image is real, and every image leads to a person you can book. A Creator's portfolio is the user's inspiration — the feed is the bridge between them.

01 / The problem

How might a picture someone loves lead straight to the person who can make it real?

"I love it, but I don't know what it's called."

People have a picture, not a service name.

"Pinterest shows me looks, not who can do them."

The maker may be abroad, unqualified or untraceable.

“I have to pick a salon before I see the work.”

Shops and stars come first; the person’s skill comes last.

“Instagram gives me likes, not bookings.”

Real work, every day — but few new customers.

> **Where this stands**
>
> Built from my product outlines, a whole-product interactive demo and a Glasgow logic and business review. Interviews and field testing come next; accounts, Creators, prices and distances in the demo are simulated.

User

Browse real work, save what they like, find who made it, compare and book.

Creator

Hairstylists, barbers, nail and makeup artists. Their portfolio is their profile, and it follows them if they change salons.

Pilot operator

Recruits the first local Creators, sets trust rules for original work and client consent.

---

02 / How the system works

Two sides, one feed of real work

One picture, two meanings: a portfolio piece for the Creator, inspiration for the user.

USERS

Who can do this look?

Browse real work | Work first, Creator after | Save · taste learns | Match a screenshot | Area · price · time | Book this look



CREATORS

How does my work bring customers?

Upload original work | Auto-tagged by style | Services · prices · diary | Requests & bookings | See what people want | Portable identity

The loop that makes it grow

01 Creator uploads real work

02 Work appears in the feed

03 User discovers and saves

04 Creator is revealed

05 Book this look

06 Service delivered

07 New result joins the portfolio

08 More real work in the feed

↻ back to Discover

Each booking can create new real work — content, supply and demand grow together.

03 / Strategy

Starting a real-work marketplace

No Creators, no real work, no feed — so supply comes first.

01 **One city, Creators who already post**

Glasgow stylists already on Instagram.

02 **Make joining effortless**

Import and auto-tag their work. Likes → bookings.

03 **A feed that is real from day one**

Users browse and match local work.

04 **Booking, then results flow back**

New results return to the feed.

Trust: original work and client consent confirmed; user uploads stay private.

Proposed business model

First-customer fee

Only for new customers — no reason to bypass.

Creator Pro

Insights, diary, richer portfolio.

User premium

Image match & AI preview; core stays free.

Sponsored, later

Labelled promotion at scale.

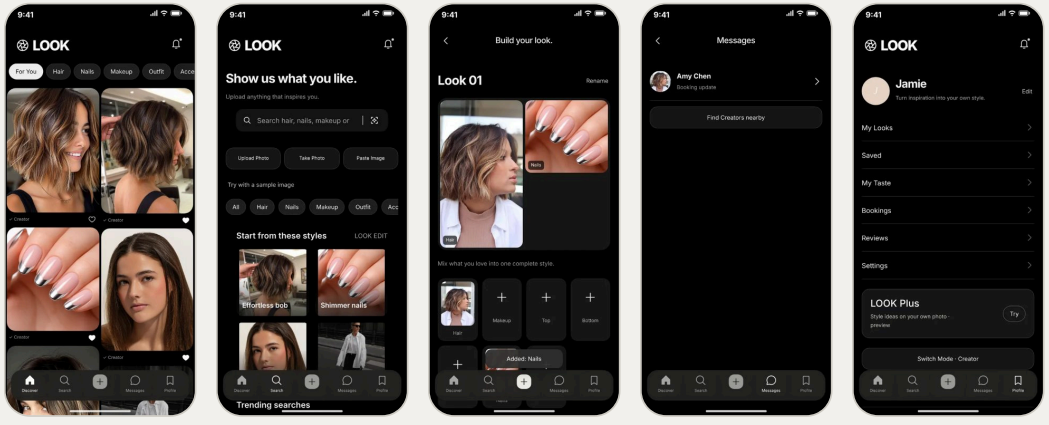
A proposal to test, not validated revenue.

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04 / Screen map

Every screen below is captured from the running prototype. Level 1 is the tab bar; each row follows one path deeper. Select any screen to enlarge it.

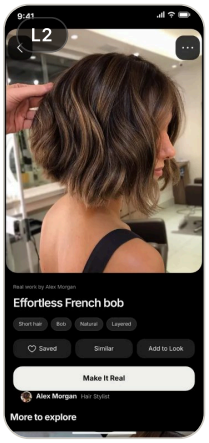
L1 Tab bar



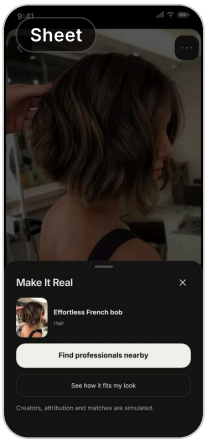
Discover Search Build Messages Profile

Key flow Discover → the core journey: from a picture to a booking

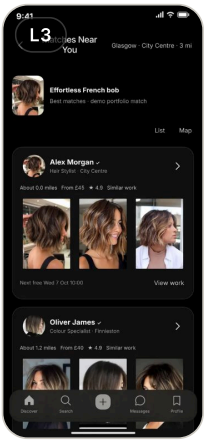
01 02 03 04 05 06 07



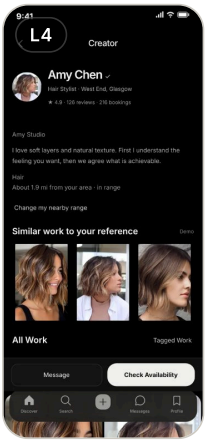
Real work, with its maker



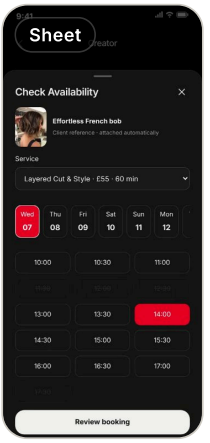
Make It Real



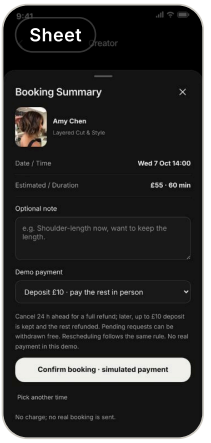
Matches near you



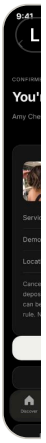
Creator portfolio



Pick a time

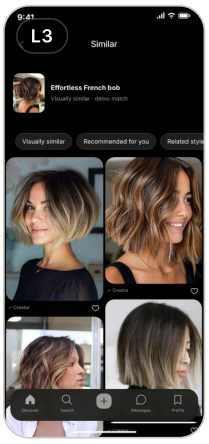


Booking summary

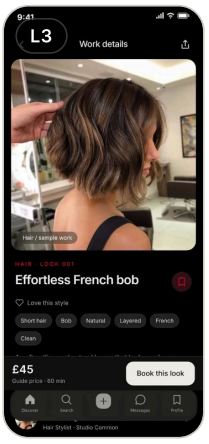


Boo

Discover → explore around one picture



Similar work



Work details & price

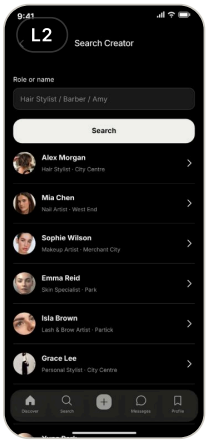


Matches on a map

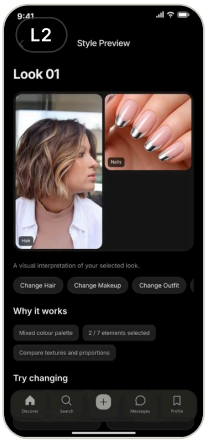


Notifications

Search & Build

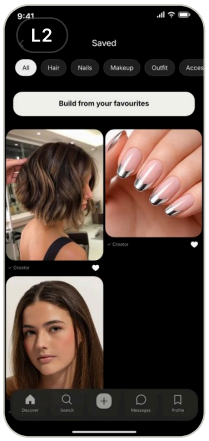


Search Creators

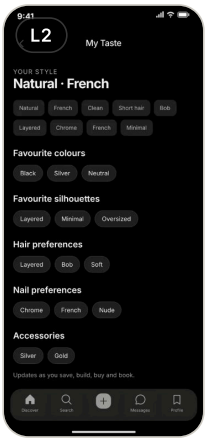


Style preview

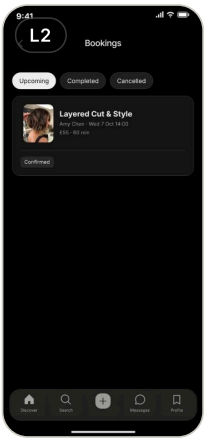
Profile



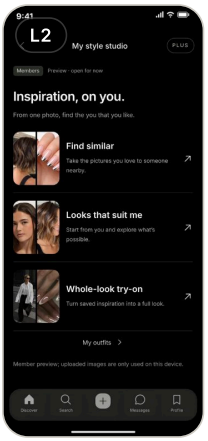
Saved



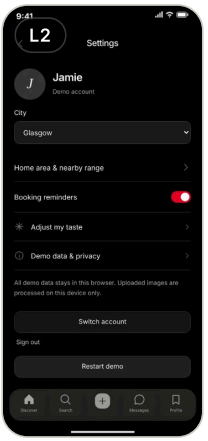
My taste



Bookings

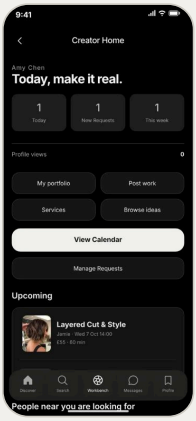


LOOK Plus studio

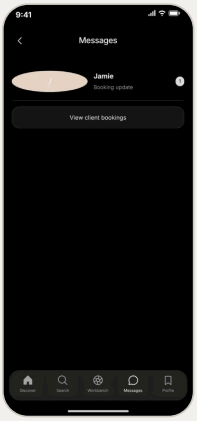


Settings & area

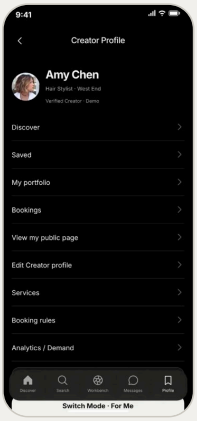
L1 Tab bar



Workbench



Messages

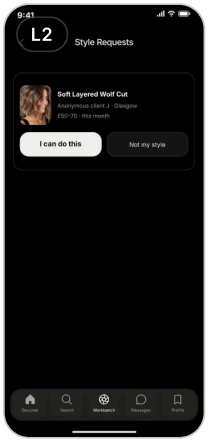


Profile

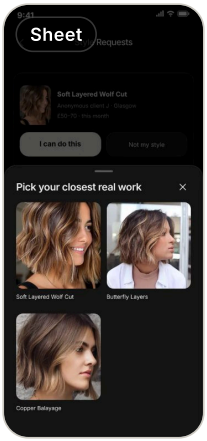
Discover and Search are shared with the user side; Creators see the same feed of real work.

Key flow Workbench → turn demand into bookings

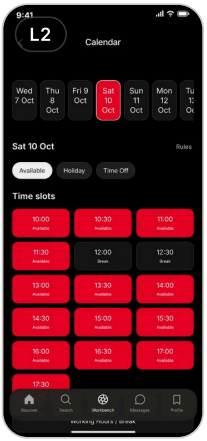
01 02 03 04 05



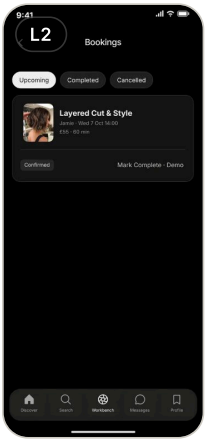
Style requests



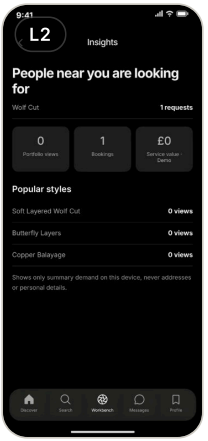
Answer with real work



Calendar



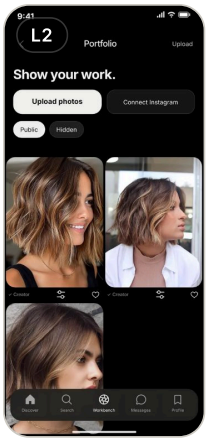
Bookings



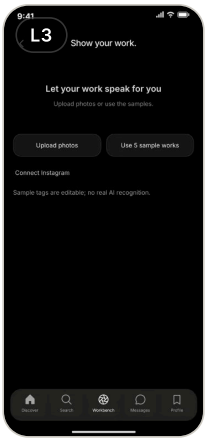
Local demand

Workbench → portfolio

01 — 02

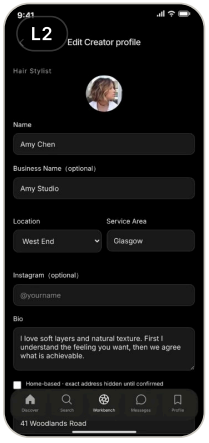


Portfolio

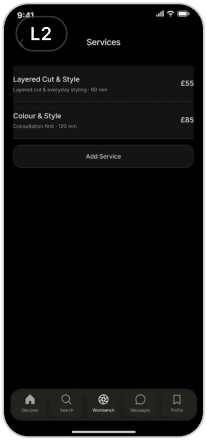


Upload work

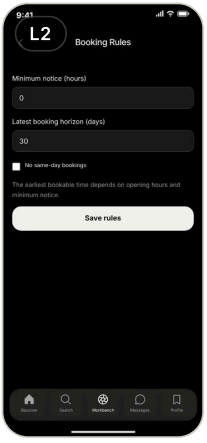
Profile → business set-up



Creator profile



Services & prices



Booking rules

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05 / The end-to-end journey

01

Discover

Browse a feed of real local work and save what you like.

02

Reveal

Open the work to see who made it, the service and the price.

03

Compare

Similar work from nearby Creators, filtered by area first.

04

Book this look

Pick a service and time; the Creator receives the same request.

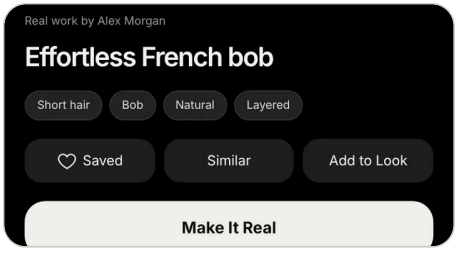
05

> **Back to the feed**
>
> The finished result can join the Creator's portfolio.

No suitable Creator nearby? The user can widen the area or leave a style request, which shows the platform where to recruit next.

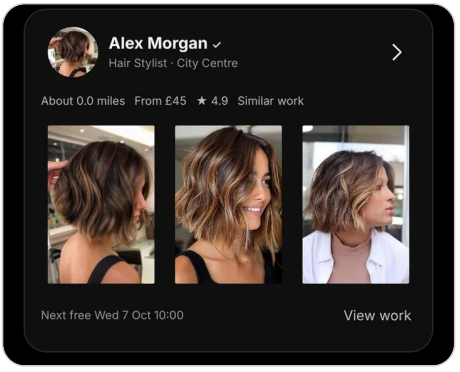
06 / Design details

Close-ups of the decisions that carry the product. Select any image to enlarge it.



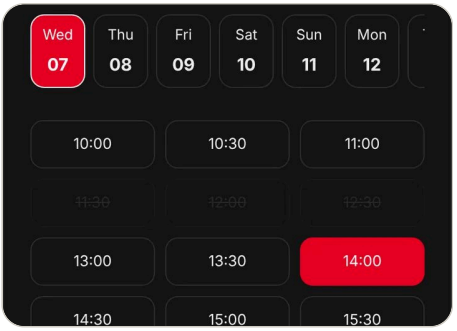
Every picture names its maker

"Real work by …" sits under the image, and Make It Real is the one primary action. Inspiration leads straight to a person.



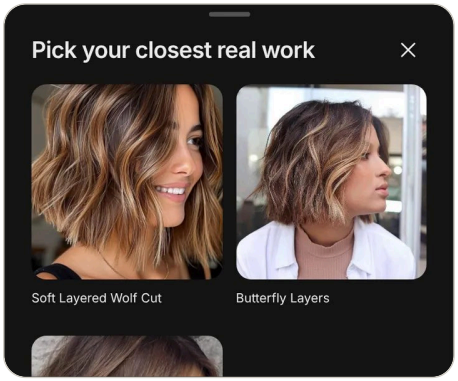
Matches show proof, not just names

Distance, starting price, rating and three similar pieces of their own work, so a user compares results before profiles.



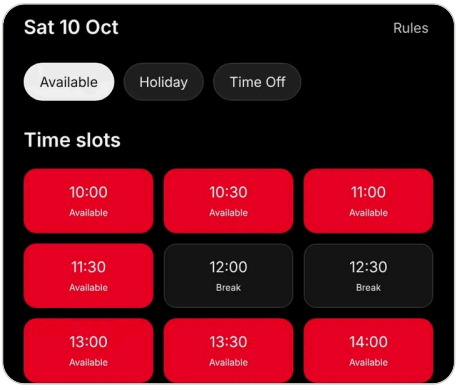
Only real free times

Times that are taken or too short for the service are greyed out; the chosen slot is the only red element.



Creators answer with their own work

Replying to a style request means choosing the closest real piece from the portfolio, so the promise is backed by evidence.



One calendar, three states

Available, holiday and time off are set per day; breaks stay visible so the Creator sees the shape of the day at a glance.

07 / Decisions & state logic

01

Location before ranking

An attractive match outside the chosen area cannot solve a local service need.

PROTOTYPE RESPONSE

Apply the distance filter before tag-based ranking; offer an editable area when location access is unavailable.

WHAT TO VALIDATE NEXT

Check whether participants understand the area limit and find relevant options.

02

Matching is not feasibility

Similar images alone cannot establish provider capability, price or time.

PROTOTYPE RESPONSE

Keep work attribution and match labels explicit; connect selection to consultation and confirmation.

WHAT TO VALIDATE NEXT

Check whether people distinguish inspiration, provider work and a confirmed service.

03

Keep both sides consistent

Availability and price can change between browsing and booking.

PROTOTYPE RESPONSE

Booking conditions are rechecked on submit, and pending requests stay visible to both sides.

WHAT TO VALIDATE NEXT

Test stale information, unavailable slots and declined requests before a real pilot.

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08 / How it was built

I wrote the product specification first, then built the prototype with AI coding tools inside clear rules, so every screen follows the same logic.

01

Specification

One written spec covers both roles: feed, matching, booking, payment rules, cancellation and privacy.

02

Prototype

A mobile web app with about 40 routes across both roles. Data stays in the browser, on one demo clock in Europe/London time.

03

Rules in code

Search radius is a hard limit, a declined Creator is not shown again, pending requests expire, and the home address stays hidden until confirmed.

04

Checks

Automated checks run every main flow and edge case, and render every route in both roles.

51

main-flow interaction checks

56

edge-case checks

80

route renders across both roles

Limits

Checks ran on a virtual DOM; the prototype has not yet been tested on real phones with real users.

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09 / Challenges, gaps & opportunities

What is hard

Cold start is a supply problem

The feed only works if there are local Creators with real work nearby. A beautiful feed means nothing if no one in range can do the look.

Similar is not the same as possible

A picture cannot show hair condition, time or materials, so a consultation or quote step is still needed before booking.

Image rights and consent

“Real work” must be the Creator’s own, with client consent. The prototype still uses reference images collected for research; before any pilot they must be replaced with consented work from real Creators.

Not done yet

- Real accounts, payments and notifications
- Postcode geocoding and travel time
- Real image matching (scores are demo values)
- Testing with Glasgow Creators and users

Opportunities

Portfolio as acquisition

A Creator’s portfolio brings first-time customers, so a first-customer fee aligns platform income with real value.

Local demand insight

Requests show what people nearby are looking for, which Creators can act on.

Personal preview, if proven

An AI preview on your own photo could be a paid feature, once quality, speed and cost are tested.

How success would be measured

- ◎ Searches with similar work in range
- ◎ Match → message → booking conversion
- ◎ Creator reply time
- ◎ Repeat bookings and shared results

Proposed measures for a pilot, not results.

10 / Validation plan

Planned fieldwork · no findings claimed yet

The next phase connects the prototype to real people and settings. The following is a research plan, not a report of completed activities.

01

Explore the real journey

Ask consumers how they collect references, explain a look and decide whom to trust. Capture consented journey notes and anonymised examples.

02

Observe provider work

Discuss consultation, feasible requests, pricing and diary management with local providers. Record actual constraints before narrowing the pilot.

03

Test one complete task

Ask a participant to turn a chosen look into a suitable service request. Record completion, hesitation, misunderstood labels and recovery from no matches.

11 / Progress & release plan

Creator identities, reviews, distances, payments and messages are simulated. Matching uses tags and rules; style preview is a collage. Browser storage does not provide production authentication or cross-device sync. A separate, narrower V1 includes persistent APIs and an iOS source project, but is not a launched product.

> **Now · connected whole-product mobile demo**
>
> Next · interviews, observation and task-based testing
>
> Then · refine a limited local provider pilot
>
> Before release · real identity, provider onboarding, privacy, payments and notifications

Local implementation checks do not establish usability or business impact. Release and a real pilot require further validation and explicit approval.